the wheel of a 1967 Corvette. I know cars; I have been driving (or at least steering while standing on my father's lap) for more than half a century. It's easy to forget incremental changes in automotive technologies that have occurred over that time. *This* new feature, *that* improved function, a new safety design, a better engineering solution.

The change from year to year is hardly noticeable, but they add up over the years.

Spend some time in a car without power steering, ABS brakes, 360 view cameras, traction control, lane departure warnings, three-point safety belts. You quickly realize how spectacular new cars have become.

Gradually, then suddenly. Perhaps that helps to explain why "Nobody knows anything."

The C2 Corvette from the years 1963–67 is a gorgeous design, a sleek, sexy, and surprisingly modern-looking car. It's (arguably) the best-looking American car—ever. But old brakes are not great, the manual steering is a beast to use, even the clutch is a bear. It has a lap belt—no shoulder belt. *The car was not even made with a passenger-side mirror!* It looks great, and sounds fantastic, but driving a 1967 *anything* makes you realize just how far automotive technology has progressed over the past half a century.

Today's cars are safe, fast, reliable, and efficient.

The same thing happened with investing. Former Federal Reserve Chairman Paul Volcker once quipped "The only thing useful banks have invented in 20 years is the ATM,"[169] but I am forced to disagree with Tall Paul.

We live in a golden age of innovation for investors, banking, and financial transactions. Financial technologies have made things so much better today than they were 50 years ago. Hell, it's ten times better than it was just a decade ago.

A few examples: